

– from the manual control of computer subsystems like BIOS settings to something as simple as printing out a document - all of them are navigated through this legacy architecture. Chrome OS on the other hand does away with a lot of the manual set ups required like system drivers, hardware installation and on-board storage in exchange for a newer user experience.

The traditional style was centred on the permanency of our data and the method in which we worked with it - using softwares which needed to be installed on our systems and negotiated by our operating systems. This dealing between the numerous softwares we used would divide our computers resources leading to common problem like system lag, instability, crashes and security threats. The intent of the Chrome OS is to simplify this structure by using the internet itself as the platform on which all work takes place. The operating system then remains a simple, thing, web-centric client that securely connects you to all your data and applications.

The important clarification needed here is that as opposed to softwares which we installed on our computers earlier, we would now use web based applications that are hosted on non-local servers along with our data. This demarcation is an essential tool of the web as the browser we use to surf is constantly accessing data on other servers with no local storage. A key example to understanding this is when you compose an email in your Gmail account the data is being worked on in Google's servers and not locally on your computer, however if you were to use an email client software like Thunderbird, the data would be composed locally and stored before being sent out over the net.

The direct access actions of the Chrome OS system over the internet is what fundamentally separates it from traditional operating systems. The idea of softwares as being locally installed tools that store, manipulate and display data using your own machines resources is done away with by Google. All these operations are instead shifted to the "cloud" i.e. application servers which perform the tasks of softwares but not on your machine, and are accessible in real-time via the internet.

In this respect the web apps or applications are the replacements for traditional software, and thus make the need for a traditional operating system redundant. These web-apps perform the same functions as their traditional software counterparts but are written in the language of the web such as JAVA, CSS and HTML, while traditional software is written mostly in C and C++ based languages. However, we know that even these traditional languages are in the process of being adapted for in-browser use